

Chapter 54-2

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When Liang Shi woke up again, the piano music in the concert hall had already stopped.

The audience had all left as well, with only a few staff members still cleaning up the aftermath.

Liang Shi almost instinctively sat up straight, then stole glances at the person beside her—once, twice, then a third time.

Xu Qingzhu didn't have much of a reaction. Seeing that Liang Shi was awake, she stood up directly, "Let's go, time to go home."

Liang Shi: "..."

She pressed her brow, feeling somewhat annoyed.

However, Xu Qingzhu walked very quickly and had already reached the concert hall entrance. She immediately got up to chase after her, but when she stood up, her legs felt a bit weak—she must have really slept for quite a while.

After catching up to Xu Qingzhu, Liang Shi asked: "How long did I sleep?"

"Not long," Xu Qingzhu said.

When they walked out of the concert hall, Liang Shi saw people coming and going outside, many of whom also seemed to have just come out, which made her believe Xu Qingzhu's words.

But before her heart could settle back down, Xu Qingzhu said: "The concert was only an hour total—how long could you have slept?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Why did it feel like she was being sarcastic?

But Liang Shi indeed knew that what she did was inappropriate. She coughed lightly and apologized: "I'm sorry, I didn't do it on purpose."

Xu Qingzhu was surprised: "I'm not blaming you."

"I blame myself," Liang Shi said. "We agreed to come listen to the concert together, to cultivate our sentiments, but I slept for such a long time. It's my fault."

"No," Xu Qingzhu said. "You really didn't sleep for very long—about half an hour."

Liang Shi: "..."

The concert was a total of one hour, and she slept for half an hour.

Half the time...

It really was quite inappropriate.

Liang Shi said guiltily: "How about I treat you to a movie next time to make up for it?"

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow: "Really feeling that guilty?"

Liang Shi nodded: "Yes."

"Then you..." Xu Qingzhu paused, pointing to her own shoulder and said: "Wash my clothes for me."

Liang Shi: "...?"

Xu Qingzhu said nonchalantly: "You drooled on my shoulder."

Liang Shi: "???!!!"

How could that be?

She was someone with very good sleeping habits!

But seeing Xu Qingzhu speak so confidently, she hesitated.

It must be true, right?

Xu Qingzhu didn't look like she was lying.

So after two seconds of silence, Liang Shi said gently: "Alright, I'll hand-wash it for you when we get back."

Xu Qingzhu stared at her, then after a moment couldn't help but laugh out loud: "Silly."

Liang Shi: "...?"

She had just woken up and was still a bit dazed, believing Xu Qingzhu's words completely.

But hearing her say this, she immediately felt a bit hurt and asked unhappily: "What's wrong?"

There was a hint of reproach in her tone.

Hearing this, Xu Qingzhu laughed and said: "I was just teasing you. You only slept for how long—how could you possibly drool?"

Liang Shi was speechless: "Fine."

Seeing her reaction was off, Xu Qingzhu moved closer and asked: "Are you angry?"

Liang Shi shook her head, but her tone was sullen: "No."

She walked forward, but Xu Qingzhu grabbed her wrist, forcing her to stop.

Xu Qingzhu said: "You say you're not angry, but who are you showing that long face to?"

Liang Shi remained silent with a sullen expression.

After a long while, she sighed: "I'm not angry at you."

"Then what's wrong with you?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi felt a bit embarrassed to say this, so she hesitated for a long time before speaking.

"I'm angry at myself," Liang Shi said sullenly. "I was the one who first asked you to come to the concert, but I fell asleep after just listening for a few minutes and even leaned on your shoulder, causing you to not be able to listen properly either. I..."

For Liang Shi, who was accustomed to not burdening others, this was psychological pressure.

But unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu laughed after hearing this: "Your way of thinking..."

She paused, changing what she was originally going to say—"isn't very good"—to "is actually quite nice, considering others."

Liang Shi: "..."

She said apologetically: "Xu Qingzhu, I'm sorry. Let me treat you to another concert to make up for it."

Xu Qingzhu shook her head and said against her conscience: "Actually, I don't really like concerts either."

Liang Shi: "Huh? But you were listening so intently just now."

Xu Qingzhu said without batting an eye: "I was pretending."

Liang Shi: "..."

Xu Qingzhu patted her shoulder: "Teacher Liang, if you really feel guilty, go buy me some cotton candy¹, and I'll forgive you."

Liang Shi: "?"

Footnotes: ¹ Cotton candy: A spun sugar confection popular at festivals and street food stalls